

Answers to every required CEO/CFO question

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1. Which five to ten country-product-entry-mode opportunities deserve the next serious diligence effort, and why?

Ten diligence markets: Nigeria (semolina/oils), Ghana (flour/pasta), Senegal (flour/feed), Cameroon (flour/rice), Mozambique (rice/oils), South Africa (grains/oils), India/Vietnam (rice origin), Brazil (soybeans/maize/wheat), Saudi Arabia (commercial grain offtake). Eighteen separate product plans, not a profitability ranking. Existing capability and a falsifiable customer/route mechanism explain selection. Ref: priority-commercial-plans; priority-product-plans.csv; slides priorities/corridor/contrast.

2. Which current operations should deepen before new-country entry?

Start with the five existing African processing/distribution laboratories and industrial customer service before new assets. Deepen only if paid contribution, capacity and monthly cash improve. No public operation-level ranking is established. Ref: priorities, customer, Nigeria; plans.

3. Which countries matter primarily as origins or corridors rather than consumer markets?

India/Vietnam/Brazil are origin and corridor hypotheses, not simply domestic consumer-market plays. Smaller trade hubs can matter via flows; all-country register leaves unverified roles conditional. Ref: corridor, contrast, country atlas.

4. Where is market growth unattractive after financing and delivery constraints?

No empirical country return ranking is supportable. The normalized plant loses money under managed and adverse worlds despite growing orders; financing and service can exclude otherwise large markets. Ref: C-DCF, C-SENSITIVITY and capital-metrics.csv.

5. Which opportunities remain viable across the plausible scenario set?

None of the three fixed normalized commitments has positive NPV in every tested world. Preserve options, reset/stop rules and actual collateral rather than call a country resilient from these templates. Ref: resilience and six-world table.

6. What changes if population grows but real household affordability deteriorates?

Separate population from paid category orders. In the affordability world orders and pass-through weaken while collection/funding costs rise; test cash ticket and cost per meal/use rather than extrapolating people into sales. Ref: demography, affordability world, pack example.

7. What changes in aging or declining populations with high purchasing power?

Declining/aging populations may favor smaller packs, convenience and specific B2B/nutrition niches, but willingness to pay is unmeasured. Japan's projection does not prove a premium opportunity; acquire cohort purchase evidence. Ref: atlas and model-selection demand card.

8. Where does climate create a new sourcing option, and where does adaptation fail?

No named new climate origin is approved: geocoded crop/basin/asset hazards and adaptation economics are absent. Candidate alternate origins must have different common exposure; hard water/rights/service limits can make adaptation infeasible. Ref: climate; climate model card.

9. Which apparent diversification gains disappear because of common origins, weather, or ports?

Shared origin, basin, port, vessel route, counterparty and currency can cancel country diversification. Chosen dependent shocks raise joint downside; the network example constrains flows without fictitious synergy. Ref: C-DEPENDENCE, C-NETWORK.

10. Where does trade fragmentation favour local processing, and where does it destroy the economics?

Local processing may reduce finished-product freight/policy risk but raises raw-input, plant, water, fixed-cost and financing risk. Fragmented-world normalized comparisons are conditional, not evidence that a particular tariff makes a plant viable. Ref: resilience; entry modes; EUDR/USDA source limits.

11. Which health or nutrition changes have purchase evidence rather than fashionable narratives?

None of the proposed nutrition premiums has observed purchase proof. Do not attribute WHO/FAO health narratives to willingness to pay. Test formulation, safety, affordable use and sustained paid repeat. Ref: products, customer and demand card.

12. Which customer problem can Olam solve profitably with a measurable advantage?

Specific hypotheses include baker saleable loaves per flour bag, cooking yield per rice/oil/semolina cash ticket and feed performance per total farm cost. Profitability requires measured price, losses, service and paid repeat. Ref: 18 product plans and C-E05.

13. What price, pack, service, or channel mechanism improves both customer economics and Olam cash?

Pack/price reduces cash ticket only if total cost per use and Olam net contribution survive packaging/distribution/returns. Technical service must improve usable output enough to pay for delivery and credit. Ref: C-E06, C-E19, plans.

14. Where is marketing the binding constraint, and where is supply, service, or credit the binding constraint?

Binding constraint is unverified in actual markets. The executed teaching case shows marketing adds orders but loses USD100 at a 100t capacity cap; with capacity120 it adds USD1,100, or USD800 net of repair. Identify service/credit/supply before spend. Ref: C-CAPACITY-MARKETING.

15. Which capital commitments should be staged, partnered, deferred, or rejected?

Defer unconditional owned-asset commitment; stage a costed controlled commercial test, compare partner/toll/contract modes and stop unsupported cases. Legacy Nigeria screen stays negative. Real project choices need contracts and cash. Ref: ask, entry modes, C-LEGACY.

16. What evidence would overturn each major recommendation?

Reverse priorities if the opportunity is inaccessible, usable-output advantage or paid repeat fails, contribution turns negative, monthly cash is unfunded or common exposure invalidates resilience. Every plan names owner and stop gate. Ref: country/product falsifiers, G0-G7.

17. What is the liquidity need in the worst credible combined stress?

A worst credible Olam liquidity need cannot be calculated from public inputs. Publish annual template funding by world, plus a separate monthly seasonal example; Treasury must supply calendar/credit/collateral/hedging and committed headroom. Chosen tail quantiles are not credible calibrated worst-case probabilities. Ref: C-DCF/C-MONTHLY/C-DEPENDENCE.

18. What proportion of value depends on long-run, terminal, or uncertain assumptions?

No franchise terminal value. Closeout and post-year10 cash are shown separately for all18 cases, including NPV without closeout and post2036 PV share. A negative net NPV makes a percent-of-net-value metric misleading. Long-run orders/costs are unvalidated. Ref: capital-metrics.csv, C-CAPITAL.

19. Which parameters deserve immediate research because they change a decision?

Immediate research: paid eligible orders, contribution per delivered tonne, usable yield, service/cannibalisation, DSO/DIO/DPO/seasonal stock, capex, legal/rights and common asset exposure. Study only if expected decision improvement exceeds quoted research and delay cost. Ref: evidence queue and C-EVSI.

20. What measurable work can I perform in the first 90 days?

Own the data dictionary, route/customer measurement, counterfactual/power specification, usable-output trials and proof-to-cash reconciliation with Finance authority. Deliver gate reviews at days15/30/60/75/90; no unapproved actual budget or sample declared. Ref: pilot-charter.

21. How will the decision model be maintained and challenged after the deck is delivered?

Named data/model/editorial owners, event and source cadence, economic alerts, model challenger and retirement criteria are specified. No automatic future monitoring job has been scheduled. Ref: monitoring-specification.

22. What is actually distinctive about the proposed analytical integration, and what is established prior work?

Established DCF, causal inference, robust regret, CVaR, network optimization and Bayesian information value are integrated around customer/physical/cash gates. Teaching examples change choices; empirical Olam superiority and exclusive novelty are unproved. Ref: prior-art, model cards, benchmarks and ablations.